

The Street Bible

Genesis / Stuff Starts up

Genesis 1:1-2:3 Something out of nothing

1-2

First off, nothing. No light, no time, no substance, no matter.

Second off, God starts it all up and WHAP! Stuff everywhere! The cosmos in chaos: no shape, no form, no function - just darkness ... total. And floating above it all, God's Holy Spirit, ready for action.

3-5

Day one: Then God's voice booms out, 'Lights!' and, from nowhere, light floods the skies and 'night is swept off the scene.

God gives it the big thumbs up, calls it 'day'

6-8

Day two: God says, 'I want a dome - call it "sky" - right there between the waters above and below.' And it happens.

9-13

Day three: God says, "Too much water! We need something to walk on, a huge lump of it - call it "land". Let the "sea" lick its edges.' God smiles, says, 'Now we've got us some definition. But it's too plain! It needs colour! Vegetation!

Loads of it. A million shades. Now!' And the earth goes wild with trees, bushes, plants,

flowers and fungi. 'Now give it a growth permit.' Seeds appear in every one. "Yesss!" says God.

14-19

Day four: 'We need a schedule: let's have a "sun" for the day, a

"moon" for the night; I want "seasons", "years"; and give us "stars". masses of stars - think of a number; add a trillion; then times it by the number of trees and we're getting there: we're talking huge!

20-23

Day five 'OK, animals: amoeba, crustaceans, insects, fish, amphib-ians, reptiles, birds, mammals ... I want the whole caboodle teeming with a million varieties of each - and let's have some fun with the shapes, sizes, colours, textures!

God tells them all, 'You've got a growth permit - use it!' He sits back and smiles, says, 'Result!'

24-31

Day six: Then God says, 'Let's make people - like us, but human, with flesh and blood, skin and bone. Give them the job of caretakers of the vegetation, game wardens of all the animals.' So God makes people, like him, but human. He makes male and female (for the "how", see later). He smiles at them and gives them their job description: 'Make babies! Be parents, grandparents, great-grandparents - fill the earth with your families and run the planet well, You've got all the plants to eat from, so have all the animals - plenty for all. Enjoy.' God looks at everything he's made, and says, 'Fantastic. I love it!'